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Data as of Oct 23, 2026 · public data only

Market or share? FedEx Freight's volume, yield and lanes from public data

FedEx Freight's daily shipments are down a quarter from their 2021 peak. Using SEC filings (FedEx, FDXF and four public LTL peers), FRED, the federal Freight Analysis Framework and FedEx Freight's published fuel tariff, I separated the freight market from FedEx-specific volume, priced the yield-versus-volume trade-off, and nowcast the Jun-Sep 2026 period FDXF reports on Oct 29.

-31.4%
FedEx Freight tonnage 2019-2024, vs -4.4% for LTL-type truck freight

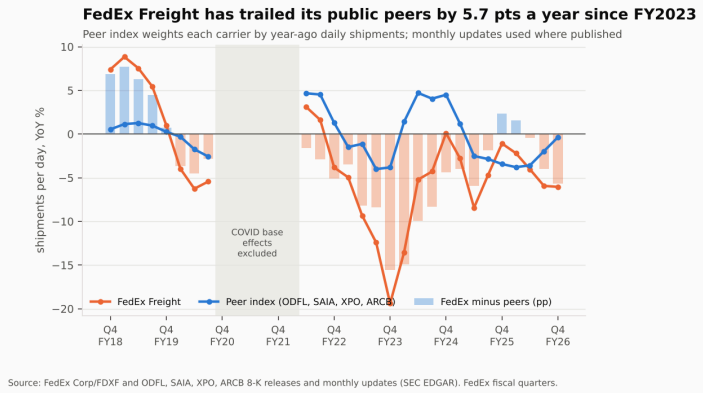
-6.0%
Nowcast, shipments/day Jun-Sep 2026 YoY (80%: -9.9% to -0.4%)

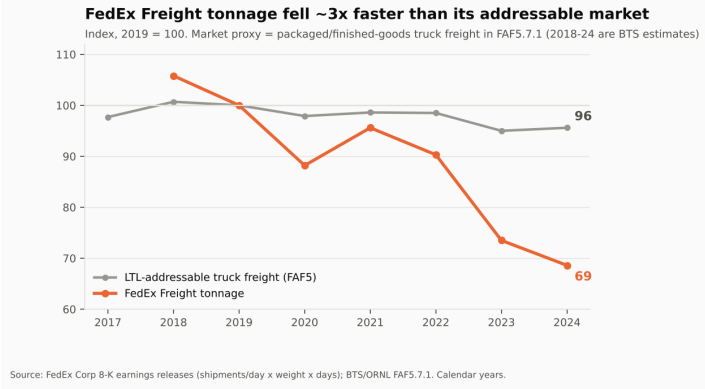
$21M
Op. income per year from 1 pt of shipments; 1 pt of price = 2.1 pts of volume

+8.1%
Fuel lift to revenue/shipment Jun-Sep 2026; -7.7% at EIA's 2027 diesel

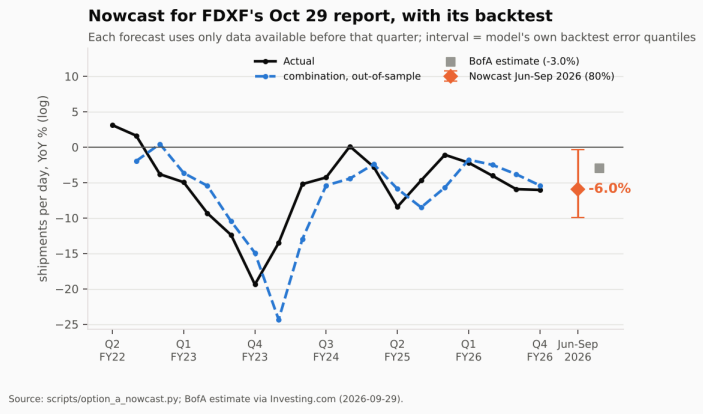
1. Market or FedEx?

- **LTL-type freight fell 4.4% by weight from 2019 to 2024** (FAF5); FedEx Freight's tonnage fell 31.4%. The level gap holds under three definitions of the market.
- **FedEx Freight's shipments per day have run 5.7 points a year behind its four public LTL peers** since FY2023 (last four quarters: +1.6, -0.5, -4.0, -5.7 points). The peer index was flat (-0.1%) over Jun-Aug 2026.
- **Price doesn't explain it.** Weight-adjusted, FedEx's price rose +2.1% to +2.7% vs Old Dominion +6.3% and XPO +3.3%, and XPO still grew shipments. That points to sales coverage, bundle unwinding and service.





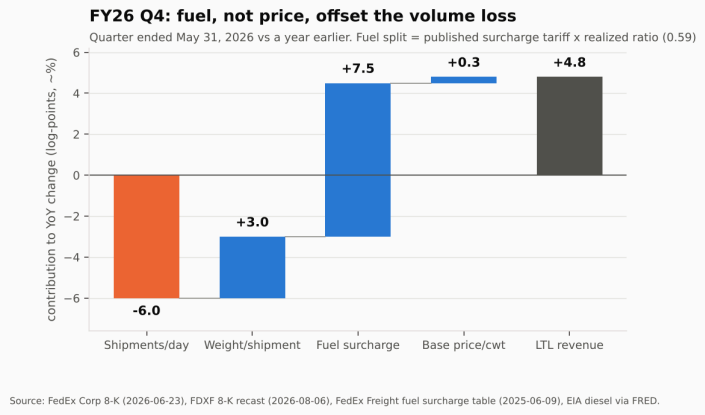
2. Nowcast for Oct 29, backtested

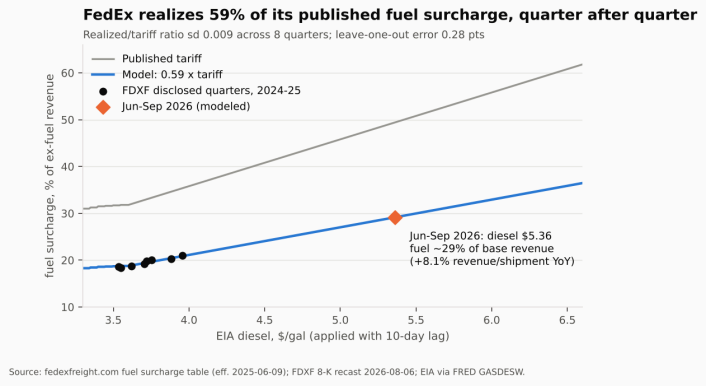


> Jun-Sep 2026 shipments per day: **-6.0% YoY** (~84.6k/day vs ~89.9k), 80% range -9.9% to -0.4%. BofA published -3.0%; management guided to exit 2026 flat to slightly positive.

Each model was refit at each of 19 past quarters on data available at the time and scored out of sample. Macro indicators alone (MAE 4.1 pp) lost to last quarter's trend (3.8 pp). Same-month peer data didn't beat it either (3.7 pp): FedEx's volume follows its own trajectory, which is what a share problem looks like. The headline is a combination fixed in advance (persistence + peers + macro); backtest MAE 3.3 pp, best of the set.

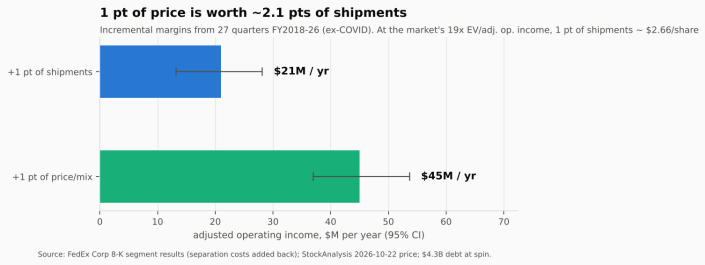
3. Yield: price, weight or fuel?

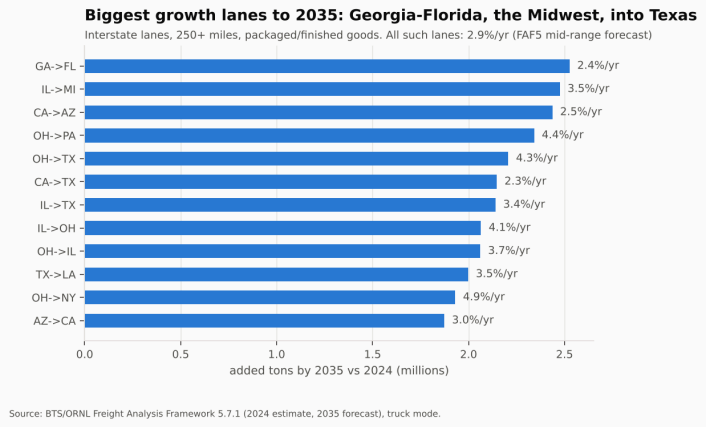




- FedEx collects **0.59x its published fuel surcharge** (sd 0.009 over 8 quarters), so the tariff splits fuel from price even at record diesel. Out of sample, FY26 Q4 base revenue/cwt comes out at +0.3%; management called it a slight decline.
- Heavier shipments lower revenue/cwt mechanically (elasticity -0.77, 95% CI -0.89 to -0.65, from Priority vs Economy with quarter fixed effects). A cross-carrier panel gives -0.57 (95% CI -0.87 to -0.26). Weight-adjusted, like-for-like price was **+2.1% to +2.7%** in FY26 Q4; weight per shipment is rising industry-wide, so FedEx's +3% is not a FedEx-specific density effect.

4. The exchange rate between price and volume





Each revenue dollar from volume added 24 cents of operating income; from price/mix, 51 cents (27 quarters, ex-COVID). At the market's ~19x EV/adjusted operating income, one point of shipments is worth about $2.66 per share.

5. What I would build with FedEx Freight's data

Retention	Account-level volume early warning (incl. formerly bundled accounts), ranked by volume at risk for the sales team. Each point retained ~$21M op. income/yr.
Pricing	Price response by lane and segment from renewals and GRIs; the 2.1:1 price-volume exchange rate as a guardrail in the new pricing system.
Revenue integrity	Predict shipment density from shipper, commodity and history; route the biggest expected differences from dimensioner data to inspection under density-based NMFC classes.
Fuel	Realized/tariff fuel ratio by contract; plan for 2027, when EIA's diesel path turns fuel into a -7.7% revenue/shipment headwind.
Network	Imbalance-aware lane pricing: Tennessee is a net receiver (-9.5%); Mountain-state lanes are heavily inbound.

Sources: SEC EDGAR (FedEx Corp, FDXF, ODFL, SAIA, XPO, ARCB), FRED (ATA, Cass, Fed industrial production, BLS PPI, EIA diesel), BTS/ORNL FAF5.7.1, fedexfreight.com fuel surcharge table, press reports of analyst estimates. Code, tests and full report: github.com/kstc707/job-search (fedex_freight_project). Independent analysis for a job application; not affiliated with or endorsed by FedEx; not investment advice.